

Drainage Board/Stormwater Board Joint Meeting, March 11th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NxGGyILUd-M
Publication Date	2026-03-12T02:33:31Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Boards: Delaware County Drainage Board & Delaware County Stormwater Board (Joint Session)

Meeting Date: March Session (Specific date referenced as March meetings; upcoming stormwater meeting scheduled for April 6th)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript indicates that the meeting opened directly with the Drainage Board call to order, followed immediately by the Stormwater Board call to order. No separate statutory public hearing or committee work session preceded the joint meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officers called to order the Delaware County Drainage Board and subsequently the Stormwater Board (00:01:15), noting the dual-purpose nature of the joint session.
- **Attendance:**
 - Members present included Mr. Borchers (Surveyor), Mr. Hamilton, Mr. Christie, Mr. Buckle, and Mr. Reagan (Drainage Board/Stormwater Board members).

- Member absent: Commissioner Henry (00:01:30, attending another meeting).
 - Presiding officers / key staff: Mr. Borchers (Surveyor), Mr. Brandt, Tommy Humbert (County Highway Department), and legal counsel (Mr. Murphy / Brook Strubal).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance (00:00:15). An administrative public safety announcement regarding an incoming severe weather front and tornado warning protocol was delivered at 00:04:03.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - February Drainage Board minutes: Approved by roll call vote.
 - January 5th and February 2nd Stormwater Board minutes: Approved by voice votes.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Drainage Board Business

- **00:15:52 Reconstruction Projects: Abe McConnell & Lock Mueller Ditches**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor) and Mr. Hamilton.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding three proposed alternatives for the Abe McConnell reconstruction with Mr. Miller from Denny. For the Lock Mueller ditch (700 East), the project is currently in Task 1 engineering phase. County Highway Department (Tommy Humbert) discussed right-of-way limits, field easements, and cost-sharing considerations for side ditch reconstructions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no final vote taken as engineering solutions are still being finalized.
- **00:24:46 New Business: Gerald Davis Perimeter Drain Tie-In**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Gerald Davis requested to tie a 4-inch perimeter drain from a new septic/rebuilding project (following a house fire) into the 12-inch Sam Davis regulated tile (located near 600 South, east of Honey Creek). The Surveyor noted this will not negatively impact drainage since the yard already drains into the tile.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the tie-in made and seconded; **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote 00:26:06.
- **00:26:16 DNR Request to Vacate Part of Chaffa Ditch**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor) / Paul Shriver (Blackford County Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The DNR requested to vacate a section of the Chaffa Ditch/tile to facilitate wetland mitigation on a 55-acre parcel for sale near Highway 35 and Mount Pleasant. The Surveyor and board members noted that vacating a

middle section would cut off maintenance for 1,500 to 2,000 feet of active tile to the south. Alternative discussed: requiring non-perforated tile replacement funded by DNR via a formal petition and public hearing process.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to direct the Surveyor to inform DNR that a formal petition and statutory public hearing are required to proceed.
- **00:29:43 Old Business: Paint Shoemaker Tile Quotes**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quotes for replacing 1,400 feet of washed-out tile south of Highway 35. Only one sealed quote (from Butler) was received by the deadline.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred. The Surveyor will re-verify emails for missing quotes and review if the project falls under the \$10,000 threshold for administrative award.
- **00:31:50 Debrushing Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update provided on debrushing contracts awarded last month. JJC Excavating (Jiren) is active on the Mo Road/Farmington project; other contractors have not yet reported.
- **00:32:46 Approval of Maintenance Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board members and Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of maintenance claims, including a beaver dam removal work order (Wildlife Solutions) and JJC Excavating sinkhole repairs (noting a minor account coding error to be corrected from gasoline/oil).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve claims made and seconded;
Approved by Voice Vote 00:35:51.
- **00:36:20 Guest Presentation: Blackford County Surveyor Paul Shriver**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Paul Shriver (Blackford County Surveyor) and Commissioner Dan Borgenheimer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Shriver discussed coordination on the joint Blackford-Delaware County Fiddler Ditch board, emphasizing the need for Delaware County property/acreage data. He also advocated for establishing a Cumulative Drain Fund through the County Council, noting it generates vital non-assessment revenue for rural tile and excavator-based maintenance without altering property taxes.

Stormwater Board Business

- **00:44:42 Old Business: Stony Creek Drive Update (Mr. Young Issue)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** DNR permit approval is expected around March 23 pending public notice. A contractor removed the primary log jam and provided a sealed quote for installing gabion baskets.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Left on old business pending permit issuance and quote review.
- **00:47:45 Orchard Street / Hickory Lane Drainage Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brandt / Tommy Humbert (County Highway).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following heavy rain events and leaf accumulation complaints, county staff cleared debris from catch basins, noting that water drained effectively within a few hours.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Maintained on old business for one additional month to monitor through upcoming spring rains.
- **00:49:40 Ken Drive Drainage & Paving Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers (Surveyor) / Sherry.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion of pipeline routing options (straight through woods vs. through residential yards) prior to road paving. Staff plan to coordinate with contractors (Butler and Abbright) to develop an RFP and ensure clear, comparable bids.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Continued under old business.
- **00:54:44 Cowan Alley Blind Tee Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Waiting on favorable weather for installation; safety holes have been covered.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Continued on agenda.
- **00:55:13 Crypto Mining Farm (332 Park 1) Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney (MS4 Coordinator) & Mr. Borchers.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Operators requested county funding to move storage containers, which staff firmly rejected. Grading work and container removal remain delayed past previous winter/February estimates.
- **00:56:23 Log Jams on White River (County Road 900 West)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion of a major log jam. Previous contractor quotes were void because logs must be removed entirely from the floodway rather than placed on banks. Coordination with Flatland Resources (working on a Daleville kayak launch project) is underway to avoid duplicate permitting.
- **00:59:55 County Road 700 West (Mel Green Damage / Coups Quote)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Heather / Courtney.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Received a quote from Coups (\$4,474.41) to regrade, rip wrap, and restore flow lines. Board discussed putting together an RFP and coordinating reimbursement with the responsible landowner.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Continued for RFP development.
- **01:01:17 Dinnotto Drainage Issues (Barrel Culverts)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Borchers & Tommy Humbert.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Long-standing safety and drainage concerns regarding failing 55-gallon steel drums used historically as driveway culverts. Staff highlighted this as a severe community need requiring future reconstruction funds.
- **01:05:27 MS4 Coordinator & Construction Reports**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney (MS4 Coordinator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual report numbers (IDDE) are being finalized for the April 1 deadline. Department head training is set for March 31. Recent enforcement actions include fines issued at Foundry Row (Cowan Road) for windblown trash, and a stop-work order at SR 3 and SR 28 for unpermitted disturbance over an acre. Contractor workshop has 55 registered attendees.
- **01:07:34 Joint Drainage & Stormwater Policy Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board members, Mr. Hamilton, and legal counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive discussion regarding jurisdictional overlaps, "catch-22s" between county boards, city engineering, and the Muncie Sanitary District (specifically regarding Morningside, Twickenham Ditch, and Walmart South areas). Agreed to draft a joint memorandum of understanding (MOU) / white paper defining statutory purviews (regulated drains vs. municipal stormwater, unincorporated vs. incorporated) to publish on public websites.
- **01:21:11 Stormwater Fee Financial Review & Rate Analysis**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brook Strubal (Legal Counsel) & Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of legal memorandum outlining the statutory steps to adjust stormwater user fees (financial review, board review, public hearing per IC 5-3-1, County Council approval, Board of Commissioners adoption via ordinance, and administrative implementation).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to authorize staff/legal to draft an RFP for a financial review and rate analysis made and seconded; **Approved by Voice Vote 01:22:58.**
- **01:24:27 Stormwater Maintenance Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of February 5 maintenance claim totaling \$286.87.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve claims made and seconded; **Approved by Voice Vote 01:24:55.**

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:02:13 Tammy Harris (2001 East Purdue, Muncie - Morningside Neighborhood Association):** Addressed the boards regarding failing, rusted metal culverts and drainage ditch hazards along Harvard Street (starting near 1909 East Harvard). Noted standing water, mosquito breeding, and safety dangers, expressing frustration over jurisdictional finger-pointing between the county, city, and sanitary district.

- **01:25:02 General Public Comment:** Presiding officer called for additional public comment; none was brought forward.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Next joint/stormwater board meeting scheduled for **April 6th at 10:30 AM**, immediately following the Commissioners' meeting.
 - **Adjournment:** Motions to adjourn the Stormwater Board and Drainage Board meetings were offered, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote** (**01:25:41 - 01:25:56**).
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